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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Litigation Legal Assistant role in Bexleyheath because litigation support is where my practical experience is strongest, and this role offers the kind of varied caseload exposure that I want to build on at this stage of my career.

My most relevant experience is the year I spent at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner, where I supported two litigation teams across international arbitration and real estate disputes. In the arbitration rotation, I became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant submission deadline. That meant coordinating documents across the matter, tracking outstanding actions and helping ensure everything was filed on time, which is directly comparable to the file and deadline management this role involves. I also maintained structured electronic case files throughout, and liaised with the client about required documents and with an external translator about Romanian-language materials. In the real estate disputes rotation, I prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments, conducted legal research on leasehold and landlord and tenant issues, and handled matter opening and closure using iManage.

At Citizens Advice, I have continued developing the client-facing side of legal support. I take detailed factual statements from clients, prepare correspondence and document schedules, and manage matters from first instruction through to submission while keeping accurate case records. Many of my clients are in difficult circumstances, so translating procedural requirements into plain, practical guidance is a regular part of the work.

I am drawn to this role because a busy litigation department with a varied caseload is the environment where I have consistently learned the most. Working across different matter types at BCLP showed me how quickly exposure to a range of disputes builds both legal understanding and practical confidence, and I want to continue developing in that kind of setting. My LLM in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution, which I am completing this year at Queen Mary, sits alongside that practical background rather than replacing it.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application further.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva